



FIYMA Program

1st July 2026

Safeguarding Requirements, Commitments and Implementation Approaches

MARGARET KIKUVI, GENDER YOUTH AND SOCIAL INCLUSION ADVISOR, MESPT



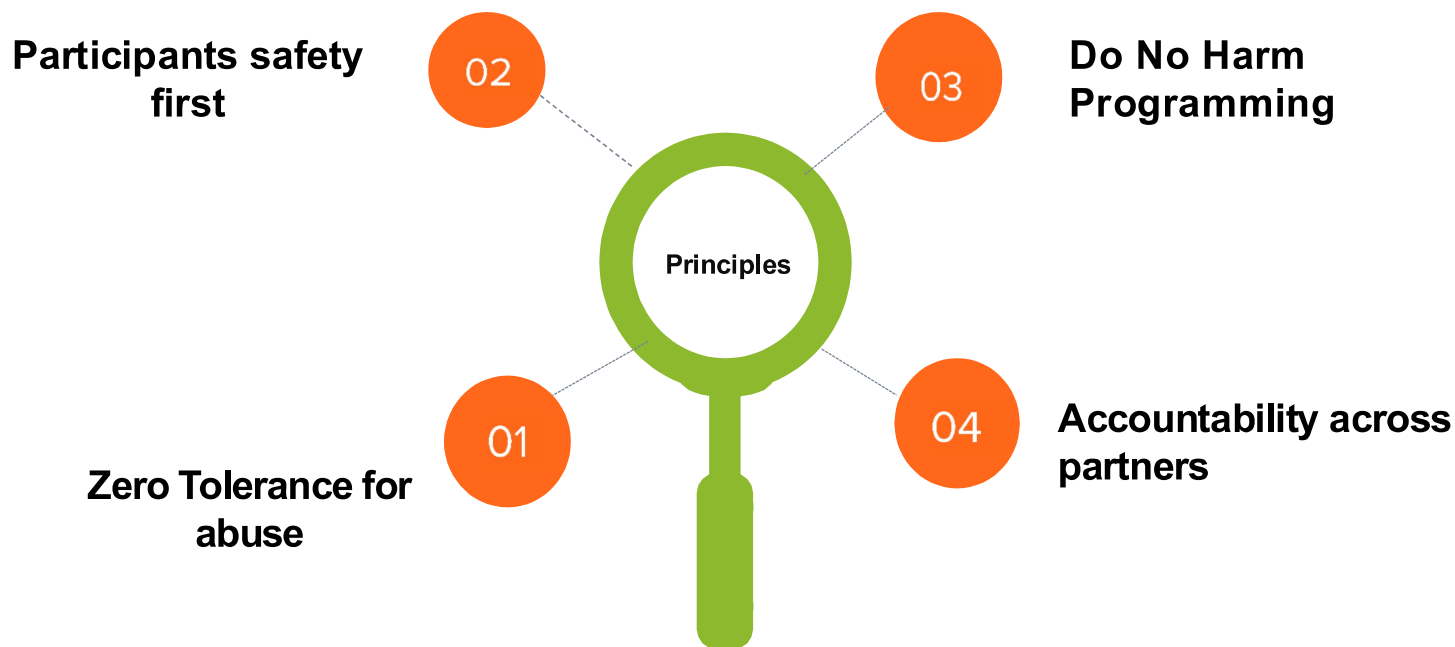
Safeguarding Context & Rationale

- The FIYMA Program targets to have at least 250,000 financially disadvantaged young people in work by working with 2000 SMEs and 100,000 financially disadvantaged young people in 20,000 groups. 80% of participants is expected to be young women , 7.5% people living with disabilities and 2.5% refugees who have higher rates of poverty
- This will be achieved through:
 - Increased access to affordable credit for MSMEs owned and operated by young,
 - Accessing finance and business development services to grow their MSMEs resulting in increased incomes;
 - Direct and indirect work opportunities created and/or improved
 - increased business sophistication and, in some cases, registered as new SACCOs to access further financing.
- All program participants are considered **persons at risk**.

The FIYMA Program Safeguarding Guidelines

- The purpose of the guidelines is to prevent and respond to harm, abuse, exploitation, and discrimination affecting program participants, program staff, financial institutions, agri-SME partners, trainers and mentors, all players in the targeted value chains, contractors and vendors, community facilitators, Community Resource Persons, interns, and community members participating in FIYMA's agribusiness and financial inclusion programs by providing a safe, inclusive and non-discriminatory environment the young people.
- The Consortium partners are committed to upholding The Universal Declaration of Human Rights, and all third parties that work as contracted parties within FIYMA are required to comply with the entirety of that Convention, applicable key principles of which have been incorporated into the minimum guidelines

The Mastercard Foundation's Safeguarding Commitment



The FIYMA Program Safeguarding Guidelines: Risks

- Various safeguarding risks may affect the program participants including exploitation during loan access, gender discrimination during SACCO lending, harassment in the targeted value chains, exclusion in the financial products access, pressure to repay the loans, group lending coercion, exploitative intermediaries, fraud and misinterpretation, exploitation by the buyers, unsafe working conditions, child labour in farms and, gender harassment in markets.
- FIYMA Program commits to mitigating all these risks
 - Pre-activity **safeguarding risk assessments**
 - Identify gender-based and financial exploitation risks
 - Apply mitigation measures before execution

The legal instruments that inform the guidelines

- Article 19 of the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child 1989
- The United Nations Convention on the rights of Persons with disabilities(UNCRPD)
- The Universal Declaration of Human Rights 1948.
- The Kenya constitution of 2010 Articles 53(Children),54(Persons with disability),55(the youth),56(Minorities and Marginalised groups) and 57(older persons-in line with working with the young people)
- Children's Act of 2022, persons with disability Act of 2025 , Employment Act 2007, Kenya Data protection Act 2019

The Scope

- All consortium partners and individuals who are involved in carrying out FIYMA Program directed at working with the program participants. These including contractors, sub-contractors, employers, security (including their employees, volunteers, directors and officers and any other personnel), trainers, mentors, volunteers, champions and Community Resource Persons as well as any consultants or affiliates that may work with such contractors or subcontractors, as applicable (collectively referred to as “third parties” throughout this document).
- All Consortium partners are required to adopt their own policy to protect Program Participants.
- All Consortium partners are expected to create awareness through periodic training and signing of the code of conduct for all their staff/personnel and third parties.
- Safeguarding clauses will also be embedded into all contract documents for the Consortium partners personnel and participating/engaged suppliers/vendors.

The Minimum Guidelines

- 1. Prevention:** measures will include Consortium partners policies, procedures and codes of conduct for protecting Program Participants; highest standard of staff selection, recruitment and verification; capacity building for all those who work with Program Participants; meaningful Program Participants engagement and participation at all levels; and awareness raising and good practice for minimizing the risks to Program Participants.
- 2. Screening Procedures:** Detailed screening procedures for all FIYMA Consortium partner's personnel who will come into contact with Program Participants, Police clearance(renewed annually), verification that applicants are not listed in national registries of child offenders including US and UN exclusion checklists;.

The Minimum Guidelines

3. Acknowledgement: Each applicant including vendors/suppliers who wishes to work with FIYMA Program will be required to sign an acknowledgment form/code of conduct confirming that he/she agrees to comply with the policy on the protection of Program Participants for the FIYMA Consortium partner and that he/she understands that disciplinary action will be taken against anyone found guilty of abuse of a program participant.

4. Awareness: The FIYMA Consortium partners will ensure that all their personnel involved with Program Participants are aware of the Program Participants' protection risks, policies and procedures, including national laws and international instruments, as applicable.

The Minimum Guidelines

5.Risk Assessment: The Consortium partners will put in place tailored measures to assess, analyze and reduce safeguarding risks associated with the program, partnership with other implementing partners (downstream partners) and the community as well as with functional areas of their program partners and implementers such as human resources, communication, research, among others

6.Gender Equality and Non-Discrimination: The Consortium partners will ensure that all policies and procedures to protect Program Participants consider gender equality and non-discrimination requirements. Recognizing that women and men may face different risks relating to their safety and protection and that all Program Participants have the equal right to protection, irrespective of race; color; sex; language; sexuality; disability; religion; political or other opinions; national, social or indigenous origin; property; birth or other status.

The Minimum Guidelines

7. Capacity Building: The FIYMA Program Gender Lead will develop the capacity of all Consortium partners' personnel who work with and for the program to appropriately prevent, detect and respond to Abuse and Exploitation of Program Participants as reflected in these Guidelines. Efforts will be made to ensure FIYMA Program policies and practices are understood and can be effectively implemented through on-going training courses for all such Consortium partners' personnel. The suite of policies will include (1) a policy on appropriate cyber-conduct which outlines rules for behaving properly online and (2) a policy on cyber-bullying which outlines rules on conduct that is derogatory, illegal and/or abusive towards Program Participants.

The Minimum Guidelines

8: Participation of Program Participants: Whenever taking steps to prevent, respond to or monitor incidents of Abuse or Exploitation, Consortium partners' personnel must consult with the Program Participants on the matters under review. Program Participants must not be treated as simply objects of concern but rather listened to and taken seriously and treated as individual people with their own views.

9: Reporting Mechanisms for Program Participants: Mechanisms will be established that enable Program Participants to safely report any concerns relating to their well-being, safety and protection to the Consortium partners. Program Participants will be aware of the mechanisms available to them and services will be confidential through anonymized reporting modalities including toll free lines, suggestion boxes and digital platforms including whistle blowing. Consortium partners' personnel will be able to identify and address concerns involving Protection of Program Participants, considering the Best Interests of Program Participants.

The Minimum Guidelines

10: Response and Follow Up: Consortium partners' policies and procedures will include appropriate measures to support and protect Program Participants when concerns arise. All measures taken to respond to Abuse or Exploitation shall respect the rights of Program Participants, local laws and consider their best interests, and endeavor to ensure no further harm comes to the Program Participants, as applicable, as a result of any actions taken by Consortium partners. Efforts to work in conjunction with other service providers, specialists, parents, legal guardians, caregivers and others will be explored when appropriate upon the consent of the Program Participants in question. After any incident or report of Abuse and Exploitation, proper measures will be taken to ensure Consortium partners' learning, evaluation and follow up takes place.

The Minimum Guidelines

10: Response and Follow Up: (continued) The Consortium partners will retain written records of all reports of abuse of a program participant, including, but not limited to the date of the report and the date of the alleged Abuse, the name and address of the program participant and his/her parent(s) / legal guardian(s) (if applicable); the name of the Consortium partner Personnel who made the report; the name of the governmental contact to whom the report was made and a clear description of the facts that led to the report; as well as any other available information. The Consortium partners will advise its insurance provider of the complaint of program participant abuse, as applicable, and retain records of any such reports. The Consortium partners will also advise the FIYMA Gender Lead of any complaints of program participants' abuse either in writing or by email.

All such records will be kept within the files of the Consortium partners in accordance with the privacy and confidentiality policies of the Consortium partners'

The Minimum Guidelines

11. Implementation, Monitoring and Review: The implementation and monitoring of the policy to protect Program Participants at risk for each Consortium partner will be designated to a specific employee within the Consortium partners' personnel. The designated employee will have the duty to review the policy at regular intervals as determined necessary by Consortium partners', preferably at least every three (3) years, where possible.

The Minimum Guidelines

12. Sanction and Discipline of Consortium partners' Personnel: The Consortium partners' will include within their policies to protect Program Participants a statement indicating that where an allegation is made that Consortium partners' personnel has committed abuse of a program participant, the accused personnel will be immediately suspended from all duties with the Consortium partner (with pay, if applicable) to protect Program Participants from further potential harm.

Where Consortium partners' personnel is *convicted* of Abuse of a program participant, the said personnel will be immediately terminated with cause from his or her position. Where Consortium partners' personnel is terminated as an employee or volunteer, such personnel will not be permitted to enter onto the Consortium partners' premises or participate in activities of the Consortium partners' following termination

The Minimum Guidelines

13:Informed Consent: The Consortium partners will provide Program Participants with all necessary details to make an informed decision regarding their participation in Program's activities, including any voice recordings, video or photographs of Program Participants. The Program Participants will understand how their images may be used and be supported to identify and evaluate any associated risks. Personal information and/or images of Program Participants will only be used after informed consent has been obtained in writing from the Program Participants, and/or their parent(s) / legal guardian(s) (if applicable).

14:Protection of Personal Information: Personal information regarding any program participant, whether or not such information is obtained as part of the FIYMA Program involving Program Participants, will not be disclosed to any third party, except in accordance with the policies of the Consortium partners' or as required by applicable local laws. Personal information includes, but is not limited to, any information that can be linked to a program participant or used to identify them.

The Minimum Guidelines

15:Conduct of Consortium Partners: Each Consortium partner is required to ensure that their personnel avoid any behavior or conduct that compromises the safety and protection of Program Participants within its activities and operations. **Consortium Partners' Personnel MUST: Prevent**

- a. Be aware of potential risks and take appropriate action to minimize risks.
- b. Create an environment where concerns can easily and safely be raised and discussed.
- c. Recognize and remedy potential situations which may lead to violent acts against program participants.
- d. Ensure that ALL one-on-one interaction with Program Participants is done in plain view of other people, that is in an open public space, in the same room as another person or in a room with large windows which permits others to clearly see into the room.

The Minimum Guidelines

15:0 (continued) Create a Friendly Environment: Contribute to an environment where Program Participants are respected and encouraged to discuss their concerns and rights

- a. Ensure that Program Participants are aware of their rights, policies and resources which are available to them if there is a problem
- b. Work with Program Participants to define what is acceptable or unacceptable behavior with Consortium partners' personnel.

Report and Respond: a) Report to the Foundation any concerns involving protection against abuse of program participants (whether by Consortium partners personnel or by the Program Participants themselves) and take appropriate action.

b) Ensure the program participants are well-informed and participate in the decision-making and the types of intervention agreed upon.

Consortium Partner staff **MUST NEVER**

- a. Abuse or exploit a program participant or behave in a way that places a program participant at risk of harm.
- b. Exchange money, gifts, employment, goods or services for sex with a program participant including sexual favors or other forms of humiliating, degrading or exploitative behavior or any other behavior that could be deemed exploitative of a program participant.
- c. Have a program participant they are working with stay overnight at their home unsupervised or sleep in the same room or bed with a program participant.
- d. Do things for the program participant of a personal nature that they can do for themselves.
- e. Offend, insult, humiliate or degrade a program participant or perpetrate any form of emotional abuse.
- f. Discriminate or provide favorable treatment to one program participant.
- g. Restrain a program participant.
- h. Discipline a program participant using any form of physical contact, or emotional or psychological pressure, abuse or intimidation.
- i. Kiss or coaxing a program participant to kiss the consortium partners personnel

Consortium Partner staff **MUST NEVER**

- j. Engage in external hugging, tickling, or coaxing of a program participant to hug the Consortium partner personnel.
- k. Carry a program participant including their child/children or have them sit on the lap of the Consortium partner personnel.
- l. Be alone with a program participant.
- m. Engage in prolonged physical contact with a program participant.
- n. Cross the safe distance of the program participants when engaging them in activities including handing them of signing sheets, training/activity materials.

Abuse the program participant using technology which may take any of these form(s): sextortion (blackmail by threatening to publish sexual information, photos or videos); image-based abuse (sharing intimate photos without consent); doxxing (publishing private personal information); cyberbullying; online gender and sexual harassment; cyberstalking; online grooming for sexual assault; hacking; hate speech; online impersonation; and using technology to locate survivors of abuse in order to inflict further violence.

The above is neither an exhaustive nor exclusive list and FIYMA Program will consider all related actions and behavior which may compromise the rights and protection Program Participants.

Safeguarding Implementation Approach

1. System Strengthening

- Develop safeguarding policies & frameworks
- Institutionalize responsible business conduct

2. Capacity Building Training on:

- Safeguarding
- Program participants safeguarding
- Gender responsiveness

3. Continuous Monitoring

- Safeguarding integrated into MEAL systems
- Regular supervision and compliance checks



FIYMA Program

FIYMA PROGRAM SAFEGUARDING & INCLUSION REPORTING FLOW CHART



Safeguarding Outputs and Outcomes

Expected results:

- Safer financial ecosystems
- Increased trust in institutions
- Improved participation of:
 - Young women
 - Vulnerable young people

Reduced risks of:

- Abuse
- Exploitation
- Harm



EAST AFRICA
MARKET
DEVELOPMENT
ASSOCIATES

IN PARTNERSHIP WITH
MESPT
MICRO ENTERPRISES SUPPORT
PROGRAMME TRUST

IN PARTNERSHIP WITH
NCBA
CLUSA
The National Cooperative Business Association
Cooperatives International

